

# PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure Cloud Security, Microsoft Sentinel and Identity Protection

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with five years of experience delivering security across hybrid on-premises and Azure cloud environments. I specialise in implementing and strengthening security controls across identity, endpoint and infrastructure platforms, with proven expertise in Microsoft Entra ID, Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE). I understand the practical demands of the prevent and protect function within a cyber security team and bring a hands-on approach to designing security controls, hardening Azure environments and improving an organisation's overall security posture. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and have successfully led large-scale security deployments across complex, multi-site infrastructures protecting over 8,000 users.

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## CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Azure and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Entra ID, Entra Connect, Conditional Access, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), cloud identity governance and Azure security configuration
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) - Strong; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM - Expert
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Endpoint Protection:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight) - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) - Strong
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Security Controls and Infrastructure Hardening:** Security baseline enforcement, patch management, vulnerability remediation, CIS Controls and NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) and Scripting:** SOAR automation playbooks, PowerShell scripting, detection engineering
- **Microsoft 365 Security:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Incident Response:** Full lifecycle incident management aligned to National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK framework
- **Security Frameworks:** ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, CIS Controls, NIST CSF, MITRE ATT&CK

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## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

### Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Implement and continuously improve security controls across a hybrid on-premises and Azure cloud infrastructure protecting over 8,000 users, strengthening the overall security posture across identity, endpoint and infrastructure platforms
- Own the Microsoft Entra ID environment including Entra Connect sync, Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) rollout and Single Sign-On (SSO) integration, reducing identity-based risk across both cloud and on-premises resources
- Operate as technical lead for the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM deployment, writing Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection rules, tuning analytics, building SOAR automation playbooks and leading incident response from detection through to remediation
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) deployments, enforcing prevention policies, investigating alerts and conducting proactive threat hunting

- Provide practical security guidance for infrastructure and technology projects, evaluating new capabilities for security risk and recommending controls aligned to Azure best practice
- Strengthen Azure security capabilities including identity governance, privileged access, cloud workload protection and security configuration management across the tenant
- Lead vulnerability management using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io, prioritising remediation by exploitability and business impact
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and enforce least-privilege access controls across administrator and service accounts
- Deliver executive-level security reporting, risk assessments and governance documentation aligned to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus

## **University of the Arts, London (UAL)**

*March 2022 - March 2025*

### **Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity**

- Delivered day-to-day security operations including alert triage, threat investigation and incident response across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon, reducing false positives and improving detection accuracy through ongoing tuning
- Managed Entra ID and Conditional Access policies for identity and access governance; administered MFA and SSO configuration for both cloud and on-premises applications
- Implemented Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) as part of a broader Microsoft 365 Defender deployment, improving visibility across endpoints, identities and email
- Managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies to enforce device compliance and application security
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and remediation tracking using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing regular risk reports for technology leadership
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security operations including alert processing, user provisioning workflows and compliance reporting
- Supported penetration testing engagements and co-ordinated remediation of findings to closure

## **HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)**

*February 2021 - March 2022*

### **IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure**

- Maintained and improved security controls across a hybrid SaaS/FinTech infrastructure including endpoint protection, firewall management and identity access provisioning
- Carried out vulnerability assessments and patch management across cloud-hosted and on-premises systems, ensuring timely remediation of critical findings
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities including evidence collection, risk register maintenance and internal audit preparation
- Managed user provisioning and access reviews to enforce least-privilege access across SaaS applications and internal systems

## **KEY ACHIEVEMENTS**

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- Strengthened Azure and Entra ID security posture by implementing Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM) and identity governance controls, materially reducing the risk of identity-based compromise across an 8,000-user tenant
- Led deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, consolidating endpoint and identity threat visibility under a unified Microsoft security platform
- Built and tuned a Microsoft Sentinel SIEM with custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics and SOAR automation playbooks, reducing mean time to detect and respond across the hybrid environment
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating standing administrative privileges and enforcing just-in-time access for all privileged users
- Delivered Cyber Essentials Plus certification from end to end, leading technical preparation, scoping discussions and assessor engagement
- Reduced vulnerability remediation backlog by 60% through a risk-prioritised remediation programme driven by Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io findings

## EDUCATION

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- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

## CERTIFICATIONS

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- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
  - CompTIA Security+
  - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
  - CompTIA A+
  - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)